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ARTICLE

Finland Just Showed The Christian World What To Expect From Hate Speech Laws

Boil a banana peel
It might sound strange, but it's something you should try!
Good To Know This

BY PNW STAFF MARCH 30, 2026

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We recently warned readers about what is unfolding in Canada with Bill C-9. At the time, many likely saw it as just another distant political fight -- troubling, yes, but still theoretical. Now Finland has shown the Christian world exactly what these laws look like when they are fully unleashed.

This is what "hate speech" laws become in practice.

Not a shield against violence.
Not a guardrail against chaos.
Not a narrow tool used only against genuine threats.

They become a weapon against Christians who dare to say out loud what the Bible says plainly.

And if Democrats ever regain full power in the United States and continue down the path of criminalizing dissent under the language of "harm," "inclusion," and "safety," Christians should not fool themselves into thinking America is somehow exempt. The same legal logic now devouring Europe and Canada would be imported here as quickly as activist judges, bureaucrats, and cultural institutions could manage it.

Finland has just handed the West a warning -- and many still won't hear it.

After a seven-year legal ordeal, former Finnish Interior Minister Päivi Räsänen was found guilty by Finland's Supreme Court for "hate speech" over a Christian pamphlet written more than two decades ago. Think about that for a moment. A 22-year-old publication -- written long before the current sexual ideology had become untouchable state dogma -- was dragged back into court and treated like contraband.

That alone should send a chill through every Christian, pastor, ministry, publisher, and church leader in the Western world.

Because once a government decides that biblical morality can be reclassified as "harm," there is no real limiting principle left.

How I Lost Fatty Liver Weight

Doctor's 5 words explained my weight gain: You might have fatty liver.

Räsänen was acquitted on one charge related to her 2019 social media post quoting Scripture, but convicted over a 2004 church booklet defending the biblical understanding of sex and marriage. In an astonishing act of state censorship, the court ordered the material removed from public access and destroyed.

Destroyed.

That word matters.

Because this is no longer just about debate. This is no longer about "coexistence." This is about erasing ideas that the progressive state finds intolerable.

And the most frightening part is how openly arbitrary the ruling appears to be.

Räsänen's own lawyer, Matti Sankamo, warned that the consequences of this case could extend far beyond one pamphlet or one politician. In his view, the ruling now opens the door for "any booklet or pamphlet or writing, within twenty years ago," to potentially be reexamined and criminalized in Finland. That means old sermons, archived ministry resources, forgotten church publications, faith-based teaching materials, and decades of Christian writing may now sit under a cloud of legal uncertainty.

That is how free societies begin to rot from the inside.

Not all at once.
Not with dramatic headlines at first.
But through the quiet creation of a legal atmosphere where everyone knows the state can come back later and punish what was once perfectly lawful speech.

This is precisely why hate speech laws are so dangerous. They are never truly about protecting society from obvious evil. They are about creating vague moral categories that can be expanded whenever those in power decide they no longer want to tolerate dissent.

And as one member of Räsänen's legal team pointed out, that danger is now impossible to ignore.

What stood out most in this case was just how subjective these laws really are. Over the course of seven years, multiple judges reviewed the same material -- and came to radically different conclusions. Three district court judges acquitted her on all charges. Three appeal court judges acquitted her on all charges. And even at the Supreme Court level, the court was split.

That means this was never some obvious criminal offense.

It was a political and ideological judgment disguised as law.

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In total, only a tiny minority of judges across the entire legal process found this decades-old Christian pamphlet worthy of criminal punishment -- yet that was enough to produce a conviction, a fine, and the destruction of published material. That should terrify anyone who still believes "hate speech" laws are safely limited or fairly applied.

Because what does this really mean?

It means judges can now go through Christian writing line by line and effectively declare:

You may say this sentence.
You may not say that one.
This phrase is acceptable.
That phrase is criminal.

That is not freedom of speech.

That is ideological licensing.

It is the state assuming the role of moral editor over Christian truth claims.

And once that standard is accepted, every believer should understand what comes next. Today it is a pamphlet. Tomorrow it is a sermon clip. Then a youth curriculum. Then a Christian school statement of faith. Then a pastor's social media post. Then a conference message. Then perhaps even a Bible study handed out in the wrong context to the wrong offended person.

This is how speech control expands: one "reasonable" case at a time until the boundaries of acceptable belief are drawn not by Scripture, not by conscience, and not by liberty -- but by activists and courts.

That is why this case matters so much more than one fine in Finland.

It is a warning shot to every Christian nation still naïve enough to believe that "Western democracy" automatically protects biblical conviction.

It does not.

Not when the ruling class no longer believes freedom exists to protect truth, but only to protect approved narratives.

And yet, in the middle of all of this, Päivi Räsänen has shown something increasingly rare in the modern West: courage without bitterness.

Despite years of prosecution, police interrogations, public smears, and the possibility of criminal penalties, she has not emerged defeated in spirit. In fact, one of the most powerful parts of this entire saga is that she refuses to describe it as meaningless suffering.

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The Finnish state intended this prosecution to silence Christian witness. Instead, it gave Räsänen a larger platform to proclaim the Gospel.

And her response to this ruling may be the most powerful line of all.

Even in disappointment, even in shock, even after being branded a criminal by her country's highest court, she declared: "I trust in God."

That is the dividing line in moments like this.

The modern West wants Christians to panic, retreat, compromise, and self-censor. It wants believers to internalize fear before the law ever fully arrives at their door. It wants pastors to soften sermons, churches to revise doctrine, publishers to edit truth, and ordinary Christians to decide that silence is safer than faithfulness.

That is the real purpose of these rulings.

Intimidation.

And Christians in America would be fools to think this spirit is not already moving here.

Because it is.

You can already hear the language being prepared: "dangerous speech," "targeted harm," "misinformation," "anti-LGBT rhetoric," "extremist theology," "unsafe religious expression." Those phrases are not random. They are the softening-up campaign for what comes later.

Finland has now shown us what later looks like.

A Christian woman cites Scripture.
A nation investigates her.
A court convicts her.
A pamphlet is destroyed.
And elites call it justice.

That is not progress.

That is persecution dressed in legal language.

And unless the church wakes up quickly, Finland will not be remembered as the exception.

It will be remembered as the warning.

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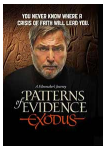

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